which the elementary quantum of action, too, must be included. In this way one can obtain the chemical properties of any given body, and thus a complete answer is found to all problems dealing with physico-chemical equilibrium. However, in questions concerned with the temporal developments of processes other forces must be taken into account, and problems about such forces are not resolved by considering the value of the entropy.

Even though as a consequence of my advancing age I have been able to take an increasingly smaller direct part in scientific research, there was compensation for this in the considerable expansion of my scientific correspondence, which I found enormously stimulating and invigorating. In this respect, I would like to mention, in particular, my correspondence with Cl. Schaefer, whose *Introduction to Theoretical Physics* I consider as pedagogically unexcelled. Our correspondence concerned his presentation of the Second Law of Thermodynamics. I also carried on an interesting correspondence with A. Sommerfeld, on the problem of the quantization of systems with several degrees of freedom. This particular correspondence even culminated in a final exchange of poetic tributes, which I shall take the liberty to quote here, although I must demur in all fairness that Sommerfeld seriously underestimated his own achievements in this field. This is how he referred to my studies on the structures of phase space:

You cultivate the virgin soil,
Where picking flowers was my only toil.

My only possible reply was:

You picked flowers—well, so have I.
Let them be, then, combined;
Let us exchange our flowers fair,
And in the brightest wreath them bind.

I have satisfied my inner need for bearing witness, as fully as possible, both to the results of my scientific labors and to my gradually crystallized attitude to general questions—such as the meaning of exact science, its relationship to religion, the connection between causality and free will—by always complying willingly with the ever increasing number of invitations to deliver lectures before Academies, Universities, learned societies, and before the general public, and these lectures have been the source of a many a valuable personal stimulation which I shall gratefully cherish in loving memory for the rest of my life.